

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	FRONT END LOADER - SAFE OPERATION	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group -Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> 	 Signature
			<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L Likely	M Moderate	U Unlikely
H (1) (High level of harm)	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) (High)	1	1	2
M (2) (Medium level of harm)	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) (Medium)	1	2	3
L (3) (Low level of harm)	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) (Low)	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Training	To prevent injuries or illness to workers	1	1. Machinery operators will have the necessary current licence or competency certificate for the equipment they will operate. 2. All persons will have a current construction induction card.	Supervisor All	2
Arriving on site	Entry unsafe or unauthorised areas	1	1. Report to site office for site induction if required. 2. Risk assessment of site conditions and Site specific induction & toolbox meeting to be conducted. 3. Consider all environmental protection issues and the impact caused by entry to site.	All Supervisor	2
Unloading Plant & equipment	Falls, slips & trips from vehicle, trucks and floats Machinery plant tipping over or falling from ramps	1	1. Ensure all vehicles are parked in a clear level area for unloading plant and equipment. 2. Extra care taken in wet conditions, use a ramp to load and unload plant. 3. Persons unloading equipment to wear seat belt. 4. Operators familiar with SWMS- Loading, Transporting and Unloading Mobile Plant-Equipment. 5. Only suitably trained personnel to work with plant	Operator	2
	Traffic hazards, hit by vehicles or other on site plant and equipment	1	1. Ensure hazard & warning signage is in place as required when unloading plant. 2. Training in the use of PPE equipment such as fluorescent safety vests/clothing.	Operator Supervisor	2
	Hand, foot & hearing damage, crushing of limbs	2	1. Training in manual handling & the correct protection, gloves and safety footwear.	Supervisor	3
Personal Protective Clothing & Equipment (PPE)	Personal injury.	1	1. Minimum PPE to be worn on site is: • Hi visibility vests/clothing • Steel toe-capped boots • UV skin protection minimum 15+ UV sunscreen • Head protection as applicable eg sun/hard hat • Long pants and long sleeves 2. Seat belt to be worn at all times.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Pre Start Check	Unsafe working conditions. Potential for accident	1	1. Pre start checklist forms filled out & defects documented, notify supervisor/leading hand of any defects. 2. Where defects are of a safety hazard park up machine and put an out of service tag on it and discuss hazard with supervisor/leading hand. They will have the hazard rectified. 3. Ensure all controls are in neutral or park. 4. Adjust the seat and use the seat belt.	Operator	2
Starting checks	Unsafe working conditions Increased likelihood of accident during operation	1	1. The operator must be seated and in full control of the machine when starting. 2. Check the operation of all of the controls and gauges. 3. Listen and watch for defects. 4. Ensure all grounded attachments are safely retracted. 5. Check safety locking pins in quick hitch are locked for buckets or attachments. 6. Test brakes & hand brake. 7. Test lights, horn and backup alarm 8. Test steering, limiting devices and all equipment controls.	Operator	2
Set out work area.	Struck by road or construction plant.	1	1. Barricade area off to restrict access and minimise plant working area. 2. All workers to wear safety vests.	Supervisor All	2
	Persons falling or tripping over on site.	2	1. Maintain good housekeeping. 2. Barricade off unsafe areas. 3. Clearly mark protruding objects using paint, caps or hazard tape.	All Supervisor Supervisor	3
	Dust entering eyes	2	1. Suppress dust using water truck. 2. Eye protection to be worn when required.	Supervisor All	3
FEL Operation	Striking personnel and plant	1	1. Hold toolbox meeting to discuss hazards including all persons to stay well clear of operating FEL. 2. Reflective safety vests to be worn at all times. 3. Where possible minimise plant & personnel in work areas.	Supervisor All Supervisor	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			4. Separate trafficable areas. 5. Install giveway and stop signs where necessary. 6. FEL to have operational flashing light and reversing beeper.	Supervisor Supervisor	
	Exposure to noise	2	1. Suppress noise using mufflers. 2. Ear protection must be worn by personnel working near noisy equipment.	Workshop All	3
	Struck by moving vehicle or objects, driving over objects on the ground that may flick up and strike another object, worker or the machine itself. Steel re-enforcement that may protrude outside the width of the bucket	1	1. Do not carry passengers. 2. Keep machine under control at all times. 3. Carry the bucket as close to the ground as possible and racked back to allow greater stability & vision. 4. Travel at a safe speed for the operation being undertaken. 5. Be aware of what objects on the travel path that may flick up or be dislodged whilst traveling over them. 6. Be aware of objects that may protrude outside the width of the bucket. 7. Ensure that no persons are within range of being struck by protruding objects.	Operator	2
	Uncontrolled slippage	1	1. Do not travel across the slope on a steep incline. 2. Assess ground surface conditions eg; wet ground conditions, steep slope.	Operator	2
Fitting & Removing Attachments	Crush hazards Manual handling injury	2	1. Take care when fitting or removing attachments. 2. Seek assistance from a workmate where required.	Operator	3
Using the FEL with bucket attachment	Various including possible death if risk controls not followed.	1	1. Before loading, check the cubic capacity of the bucket and the type of material to be handled to ensure overloading does not occur. 2. At all times carry a loaded bucket as close to the ground as possible, to just clear ground obstructions. Do not raise the bucket to unloading height until reaching the dumping point. The dangers of a high bucket are instability, obstructed vision and the possibility of striking overhead obstructions. 3. When travelling on sloping surfaces with a loaded	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			bucket, always keep the bucket facing uphill and never travel sideways on a steep incline. If necessary, prepare the sloping surface by cut and fill before taking loads up or down. 4. Never travel in reverse before looking behind to check for persons or obstructions in your intended path. 5. Major factors in accidents during truck loading operations include truck position, driver location and traffic flow. Loader operators should move cautiously, especially in congested areas. 6. The loader operator and the truck driver should agree where the driver will stay when the truck is being loaded; either in the cab, or away from both loader and truck – never on the truck body. 7. Persons are not to ride in the bucket. 8. To avoid cave-in, never work close to loose edges. Remember the loaded machine is extremely heavy when back filling deep trenches, work at 90 degrees to its edge. 9. Buckets should always be grounded when the operator leaves the cab. A bucket left elevated for any reason should be securely blocked. 10. Equipment left unattended should be locked or made inoperable so that any unauthorised person, particularly a child, cannot start the engine.		
Log grab attachment	Striking other persons onsite - death	1	1. Operator is to ensure no other persons are in the vicinity of operating area of FEL with log grab attachment. 2. All persons on site to keep well clear of operating FEL. 3. If a person is assisting in the work process the operator and offside are to keep within eye contact at all times and the offside is to move to a safe area when logs or items are being moved by the FEL.	Operator Offsider	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Road travel	Tyre puncture Struck by moving parts Steering / brake failure	1	1. Ensure the tyres or tracks are clear of mud & rocks. 2. Ensure the hinged clip between the two brake pedals is locked into position (where applicable). 3. Raise the bucket to a safe traveling height (but also keep vision clear. 4. Apply park brake if brake failure occurs. 5. Apply brake and stop if steering failure.	Operator	2
Excavating	Engine failure	1	1. Warm up engine and hydraulic oil before starting work.	Operator	2
	Obstruction to other personnel	1	2. Carry the bucket close to the ground & racked backwards.	Operator	2
	Ground failure leading to machine rollover Personnel being crushed	1	1. Only competent operators to use machinery. 2. Operator to complete visual assessment of ground conditions. 3. All unbattered excavations to be barricaded off. 4. Do not operate close to an overhang or a deep ditch or excavation the weight could collapse the sides of the trench.	Supervisor Operator Supervisor Operator	2
	Disruption to services Accidental entry of personnel may be struck.	1	1. Locate all utilities in the area. 2. Barricade of the working area. 3. Clear everyone from the operating radius of the bucket.	Supervisor	2
	Equipment damage Plant rollover , ground failure	1	1. Always approach embankments or trenches from a 90 degree angle. 2. Do not use the bucket as a hammer. 3. When working on a slope determine whether to dump the spoil on the high side or low side of the trench.	Operator	2
Lifting	Sling failure	1	1. The safe working load (swl) of the machine should be marked on the machine. 2. Do not exceed the safe work load and work radius limits of the machine.	Operator	2
	Struck by moving load/part	1	1. Check the SWL of the machine and the lifting lugs, slings & chains to ensure the load is correctly slung and balanced and is within the SWL.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
	Ground failure	2	2. If there is any sign of instability lower the load immediately.	Operator	3
	Failure during lifting	1	1. When the load is raised keep all people at a safe distance. 2. Do not swing loads over people's heads. 3. Do not leave the load suspended in the air. Lower it as soon as possible. 4. Always lower the load to the ground if leaving the machine. 5. Make allowances for materials when they are wet. They will weigh more than normal. 6. If you do not know the weight of the load do not lift. 7. When working on sloping or flat surfaces be aware of the safe bucket capacity eg; rocks falling from an overfull bucket and damaging other items or persons 8. Do not reeve or nip slings around buckets as the sling can be cut by the cutting edge or teeth of the bucket. 9. Do not place a sling over a tooth or teeth. 10. Place the lifting hook onto the approved lifting lug normally attached to the quick hitch. 11. The person who slings and directs the load must have a dogman's certificate. 12. Inspect all slings prior to use to ensure they are serviceable.	Operator	2
FEL shut down	Personnel struck by rolling plant.	1	1. Access parking area as to site vision for other works in the area (eg traffic situation on roadworks site). 2. Park on firm, level ground where possible. 3. Park the machine up and down the slope when parking on a grade. 4. Park in a non operating area. 5. Park away from deep excavations and trenches. 6. Place the transmission in neutral or park position. 7. Apply the park brake or hand brake.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			8. Lower the bucket to the ground with the front cutting edge flat on the ground. 9. Lower other attachments (rippers) to the ground. 10. Idle the engine for gradual cooling before turning it off. 11. Turn the steering wheel back and forward and cycle the hydraulic controls to dissipate residual pressure in the hydraulic system before leaving the machine. 12. Remove the ignition key and secure the machine.		
Maintenance	Personal injury	1	1. Move machine to a position away from the work site. 2. Remove keys from ignition. 3. Place a lock out danger tag on the steering wheel of the FEL to alert others that you are working under or behind machine and not to start the machine.	Operator	2
Environmental Issues	Transmission of material off site to public domain eg mud or to main road.	2	1. Where possible endeavor to not park in muddy areas.	Operator	3
	Hydraulic oil spill	3	1. Make sure there is a visual check of all hydraulic hoses is part of your pre start check. 2. Should there be an extensive oil leak- clean it up immediately.	Operator	3

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	3
Bitumen/Prime	During heavy rain, recently placed prime or bitumen could emulsify and wash into surrounding waterways.	1	1. Plan prime or bitumen operation so that it is conducted during fine weather. 2. Have material available to clean up a spill if it occurs and dispose of contaminated material accordingly. 3. Protect storm drains during and after application to prevent pollution - have spill clean-up materials available.	Supervisor All	2
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during “normal” hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste asphalt will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	
Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.						
All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card						
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)		Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required		Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management	
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training		Fire Extinguisher training		Fatigue Management Training	
A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.						
Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)						
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022						
Codes of Practice						
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020		Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018		
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020		Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019		
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020		WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018		
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018		Safe Design of Structures - 2018		
Plant & Equipment for this activity						
- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site - Daily maintenance & service checks. - Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out. - Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.						
List of plant for this Activity						
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):						

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.